Masterkey

The Westlake Village

Seller's Prep Checklist

Your complete guide to selling your home in Westlake Village for top dollar.

$1.6M	35	98%	+18.9%
Median Price Westlake Village	Median Days on Market	Sale-to-List Ratio	Year-over-Year Price Growth

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Why Sell Now?

The Westlake Village real estate market in 2026 presents a compelling window for homeowners considering a sale. With median prices at $1.6M and year-over-year appreciation of 18.9%, sellers in this luxury enclave are in a strong position. Here's why now is the time to act.

Strong Price Appreciation Favors Sellers

Westlake Village home values have surged 18.9% year-over-year, bringing the median sale price to $1,600,000 as of February 2026. At $673 per square foot, the area commands a significant premium over surrounding communities. If you purchased your home before 2020, you're likely sitting on substantial equity gains that can fund your next move, retirement, or investment goals.

Sources: Redfin, Zillow (data through early 2026)

Equity Gains Are Exceptional

With nearly 19% appreciation in just one year, Westlake Village has outpaced most Southern California markets. The limited housing stock (only 8 homes sold in February 2026) and high demand from affluent buyers continue to drive values upward. Sellers who capitalize on this momentum are positioned to maximize returns.

Source: Redfin Westlake Village housing market data

$1.6M
Median Sold Westlake Village

+18.9%
Price Growth Year-over-Year

6.5 Mo
Months of Inventory

$673
Price Per Sq Ft

The Luxury Segment Commands Premium Attention

Westlake Village's neighborhoods span a wide range, from Lake Lindero at ~$900K to Trentwood estates at ~$8.9M. The area's affluent buyer pool, with a median household income of $180,000, continues to seek the combination of lake access, golf courses, top-rated schools, and proximity to LA that makes Westlake Village unique. Well-presented luxury homes attract serious, qualified buyers.

Source: Redfin, Realtor.com, California Demographics

Balanced Market Rewards Prepared Sellers

With 6.5 months of supply and a compete score of 48/100, the market is balanced to slightly favor buyers. The sale-to-list price ratio of 98% means homes are selling very close to their asking prices when priced correctly. Homes that are well-prepared and strategically priced continue to sell within 35 days on average.

MasterKey Insight

The best time to sell is when your personal circumstances align with a healthy market. In 2026, Westlake Village offers strong appreciation, solid demand from high-net-worth buyers, and a market where preparation and pricing are the keys to maximizing your return. Don't wait for 'perfect' conditions that may never come.

Preparing Your Home

First impressions drive offers. In Westlake Village's luxury market, buyers expect impeccable presentation. The homes that are professionally staged, meticulously maintained, and showcase the lifestyle command the highest prices and sell the fastest. Here's your preparation checklist.

1. Declutter and Depersonalize

Remove personal photos, excess furniture, and anything that prevents buyers from envisioning themselves in the space. In luxury homes, less is more — buyers need to see the architecture, the finishes, and the views, not your personal belongings. Consider renting a storage unit or using a professional organizer.

2. Deep Clean Everything

Hire a professional cleaning crew for a top-to-bottom deep clean. This includes carpets, windows (inside and out), grout, baseboards, appliances, pool area, and outdoor living spaces. Budget $800-$1,500 for a luxury home. A spotless property signals to discerning buyers that it has been meticulously maintained.

3. Make Strategic Repairs

Address the items that will show up on a buyer's inspection and erode confidence: leaky faucets, cracked tiles, peeling paint, sticking doors, pool equipment issues, and broken fixtures. Budget $3,000-$8,000 for repairs on a luxury home. A pre-listing inspection ($500-$800) can identify issues before they become negotiation leverage for the buyer.

4. Stage for Maximum Impact

Professional staging is one of the highest-ROI investments a seller can make. According to RESA (Real Estate Staging Association), staged homes in 2025 sold for an average of $56,000-$101,931 above list price, with an average staging investment of just $3,588-$4,387. For Westlake Village's higher price

points, staging investment may run $5,000-$8,000, but the return is even more significant.

Source: RESA Q1-Q3 2025 Market Statistics

$5,000+	$56K+	2,334%	12 Days
Avg Staging Investment	Avg Over List Price	Average Staging ROI	Avg Days on Market

RESA Q1 2025 data. Staged homes vs. market average.

5. Boost Curb Appeal

The exterior is the first thing buyers see, both online and in person. For Westlake Village homes, this means fresh landscaping, a manicured lawn, a power-washed driveway, updated exterior lighting, and a welcoming entry. If you have lake or mountain views, ensure sight lines are clear. Budget $1,000-$3,000 for landscaping and exterior enhancements.

Pro Tip: The Investment That Pays for Itself

Total estimated prep costs (inspection + staging + repairs + cleaning + landscaping) run approximately $15,000-$20,000 for a typical Westlake Village home. With staged homes selling for $56K-$101K above list on average, and the median price at $1.6M, this investment pays for itself many times over. Don't skip it.

Pricing Strategy

Pricing is the single most important decision you'll make when selling your home. Price too high and you'll sit on the market; price too low and you leave money on the table. In Westlake Village's luxury market, strategic pricing is even more critical. Here's how to get it right.

Start with a Comparative Market Analysis (CMA)

A CMA compares your home to similar properties that have recently sold, are currently listed, and have expired (failed to sell) in your area. Your MasterKey agent will prepare a detailed CMA that accounts for square footage, lot size, condition, upgrades, views, lake access, and micro-location factors. This is the foundation of your pricing strategy, not Zillow's Zestimate.

Pricing Psychology: The Science of Attraction

Buyers search in price brackets. A home listed at $1,550,000 appears in searches up to $1.6M, but a home at $1,600,000 may only show up in $1.6M-$1.7M searches, cutting you off from a significant pool of buyers. Price just below key thresholds to maximize visibility.

Under $1,499K captures all buyers searching 'under $1.5 million'

$1,595,000 vs. $1,600,000 can make a psychological difference in search results

Precise numbers ($1,575,000) signal data-driven pricing rather than arbitrary round numbers

The Danger of Overpricing

In any luxury market, overpricing is the most common and costly mistake. With 6.5 months of supply in Westlake Village, buyers have choices. Overpriced homes don't just sit; they actively lose value. Here's why:

Stale listing syndrome. The longer a home sits, the more buyers assume something is wrong with it. Luxury homes that have been listed for 60+ days attract lowball offers and lose their cachet.

Missed buyer momentum. The first 2-3 weeks generate the most activity. If you're overpriced during that window, you've missed the buyers most likely to pay top dollar.

Appraisal risk. Even if a buyer agrees to an inflated price, the lender's appraisal may not support it, killing the deal or forcing a last-minute renegotiation. This is particularly common with jumbo loans.

Price reduction stigma. Multiple price reductions on the MLS signal desperation and invite further low offers. It's far better to price right from day one.

MasterKey Insight: Price It Right from Day One

Our data shows that homes priced within 3% of market value on day one sell faster and for more money than homes that start high and reduce. Your MasterKey agent's CMA uses current Westlake Village comp data, not algorithms, to find the price that generates maximum interest and competitive offers.

Westlake Village Price Benchmarks

Metric	Value	Context
Median Sold Price	**$1,600,000**	Westlake Village Feb 2026
Price per Sq Ft	**$673**	Community-wide average
Sale-to-List Ratio	**98%**	Homes selling near ask
Median Days on Market	**35 days**	Well-priced homes
YoY Appreciation	**+18.9%**	Strong upward trend

Sources: Redfin, Zillow, Realtor.com (early 2026 data)

Understanding Your Costs

Selling a home isn't free. Between agent commissions, closing costs, and prep expenses, you need to understand what you'll actually net from the sale. Here's a transparent breakdown based on a $1,600,000 Westlake Village home.

Agent Commissions

Since the NAR settlement in 2024, commission structures have become more transparent and negotiable. In the Westlake Village area, the average listing agent commission is approximately 2.5% and the average buyer agent commission is approximately 2.5%, for a total average of 5.0%. On a $1.6M home, that's approximately $80,000.

Source: Clever Real Estate; local market data

Closing Costs

California sellers typically pay approximately 2.7% of the sale price in closing costs. Here's what that includes:

Cost Item	Details	Estimated Cost
Escrow fees	Split 50/50 in SoCal	$3,000-$4,500
Title insurance (owner's)	Seller pays in SoCal	~$2,000
Transfer tax	0.11% of sale price	~$1,760
Natural hazard report	Required disclosure	~$100
Grant deed preparation	Legal document	~$100
Sub-escrow / messenger	Administrative fees	~$150
Recording fees	Los Angeles County	~$300

HOA docs & transfer	If applicable	~$350-$500
Prorated property taxes	Variable	Varies

Source: Clever Real Estate; Los Angeles County fee schedules

Net Proceeds Estimate

Here's a realistic estimate of what you'd walk away with on a $1,600,000 sale, assuming a $500,000 remaining mortgage balance:

Sale price	$1,600,000
Less: Agent commissions (5.0%)	-$80,000
Less: Closing costs (~2.7%)	-$43,200
Less: Mortgage payoff	-$500,000
Less: Prep costs (est.)	-$17,500
Estimated net proceeds	**~$959,300**

Pro Tip: Negotiate Your Commission

Since the NAR settlement, commissions are more negotiable than ever. Some listing agents offer tiered commission structures based on sale price thresholds. Others may reduce their rate for repeat clients or if you're also buying through them. Your MasterKey agent will provide a transparent fee structure upfront.

The Selling Timeline

From preparation to closing, here's the typical timeline for selling a home in Westlake Village. Most financed sales close in 30-45 days after accepting an offer; all-cash transactions can close in as little as 7-21 days.

1. **Prep Your Home**
   Declutter, deep clean, make repairs, stage, and boost curb appeal. Allow 2-4 weeks for thorough preparation of a luxury home. Schedule a pre-listing inspection to identify and fix issues proactively.

2. **List and Market**
   Your MasterKey agent launches professional photography, a 3D virtual tour, drone footage, targeted digital ads, MLS syndication, and social media campaigns. The first 2-3 weeks are critical for maximum exposure in Westlake Village's discerning buyer pool.

3. **Show Your Home**
   Open houses, private showings, and broker tours generate interest. Keep the home in showing-ready condition at all times. Your agent will provide feedback after each showing.

4. **Review and Accept an Offer**
   Evaluate offers on price, contingencies, financing strength, and closing timeline. Your agent will negotiate terms and counteroffers on your behalf to maximize your net proceeds.

5. **Open Escrow**
   Once under contract, escrow is opened. The buyer deposits earnest money (typically 1-3% of the purchase price). Escrow holds all funds and documents until closing.

6. **Buyer Inspections and Appraisal**
   The buyer conducts a home inspection and the lender orders an appraisal. Be prepared for a request for repairs (credits or fixes). Your MasterKey agent will negotiate to protect your bottom line.

7. **Clear Contingencies and Close**
   The buyer removes contingencies (inspection, appraisal, loan). Final walkthrough is completed. You sign closing documents at the title company, and the deed is recorded with Los Angeles County.

8. **Move Out and Hand Over Keys**
   Per your agreement, you vacate the property (typically on closing day or with a rent-back arrangement). Congratulations, your home is sold!

Timeline Summary

Pre-listing prep: 2-4 weeks | Active marketing: 3-6 weeks (avg 35 days) | Escrow to close: 30-45 days (financed) or 7-21 days (cash). Total from prep to keys: ~3-4 months.

California Disclosure Checklist

California has some of the most comprehensive seller disclosure requirements in the country. Failing to disclose known issues can expose you to legal liability after the sale. Your MasterKey agent will guide you through every form, but here's what you need to know.

Sources: Clever Real Estate; Nolo.com California seller disclosure obligations

Required Disclosures

- **Transfer Disclosure Statement (TDS)** - Required by California law. Covers the condition of all major systems: structural, plumbing, electrical, HVAC, roof, foundation, and more. Complete this form honestly and thoroughly.
- **Natural Hazard Disclosure (NHD)** - A third-party report identifying whether your property is in a flood zone, fire hazard zone, earthquake fault zone, seismic hazard zone, or other natural hazard area. Westlake Village borders wildfire-prone areas in the Santa Monica Mountains, so this is especially relevant.
- **Seller Property Questionnaire (SPQ)** - Covers neighborhood issues, noise, nuisances, insurance claims, code violations, lawsuits, and other matters that could affect the buyer's decision. Be thorough and honest.
- **Lead-Based Paint Disclosure** - Required by federal law for all homes built before 1978. You must disclose any known lead-based paint hazards and provide the EPA pamphlet.
- **Megan's Law Notice** - California requires a notice informing buyers about the state's sex offender database (Megan's Law). This is a standard form included in every transaction.
- **HOA Documents** - If your home is in a homeowners association (common in Westlake Village), you must provide CC&Rs;, financial statements, meeting minutes, and any pending special assessments. Allow 2-3 weeks for your HOA to prepare these documents.

- **Mello-Roos / Special Tax Disclosure** - If your property is in a Community Facilities District (CFD), you must disclose the special tax. Some Westlake Village developments carry Mello-Roos assessments.
- **Additional California Requirements** - Deaths within the past 3 years on the property, environmental hazards (asbestos, mold, radon), structural modifications, boundary disputes, and any pending litigation affecting the property must all be disclosed.

Pro Tip: Prepare Disclosures Before Listing

Having your TDS, NHD, SPQ, and all other disclosures completed before you list your home leads to smoother transactions and fewer surprises during escrow. Buyers who receive disclosures upfront feel more confident, and you reduce the risk of deals falling apart over late-discovered issues.

Your Next Steps

You've got the knowledge. Now it's time to put it into action. MasterKey combines expert agents with technology to make selling your Westlake Village home seamless, profitable, and stress-free.

1. **Book a Free Listing Consultation**
   No pressure, no obligation. We'll tour your home, discuss your goals and timeline, prepare a detailed CMA, and create a customized marketing plan to sell for top dollar.

2. **Get a Pre-Listing Home Assessment**
   Your MasterKey agent will identify the improvements that will yield the highest ROI, connect you with trusted local contractors and stagers, and help you prioritize your prep budget.

3. **Launch Your Listing with MasterKey**
   Professional photography, 3D tours, drone footage, targeted digital marketing, and a dedicated listing specialist who knows Westlake Village inside and out. We handle everything so you can focus on your next chapter.

Meet Your MasterKey Team

MasterKey was built by two brothers who believe selling a home should be powered by technology and guided by expertise. Here's who you'll be working with.

Mark Mathias

Co-Founder / Principal Broker

With a background in SaaS sales leadership and product management, Mark brings a strategic, tech-forward approach to every real estate transaction. His goal: make selling your Westlake Village home a seamless, profitable experience.

Michael Mathias

Co-Founder / CTO / Broker

Michael's expertise from leading ad-tech platforms for clients like Google and Nike powers MasterKey's technology-driven approach. He ensures every client gets cutting-edge marketing tools and maximum exposure.

Ready to Sell Your Home?

Visit www.usemasterkey.com/contact to schedule a free consultation or DM us **'SELLGUIDE'** on social media to connect with a Westlake Village listing specialist.

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute financial, legal, or real estate advice. Market data is sourced from Redfin, Zillow, Realtor.com, Clever Real Estate, RESA, and Freddie Mac as of early 2026 and is subject to change. Always consult with qualified professionals before making selling decisions. MasterKey is a licensed real estate brokerage in California.